



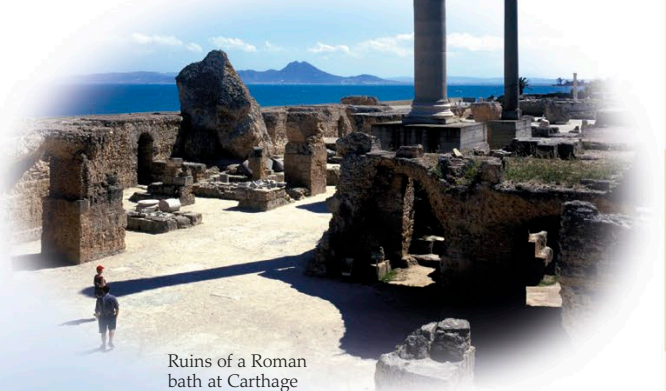
DATE PALMS

Dates are an important crop for Algeria and Tunisia. Date palms are often grown at oases, where water lies close to the surface of the desert. Here, the clusters of dates are shown ripening beneath polythene. Leaves from the trees can be used for thatch and the trunk is cut for timber.



ANCIENT RUINS

Phoenicians, Romans, and Greeks from ancient times have all left their mark on this part of Africa. Today, tourists come to admire the historical sites along the coast. These ruins of Carthage, near Tunis, date from 146 BCE, when Romans laid waste to this city. The Romans went on to control all of the north African coast.



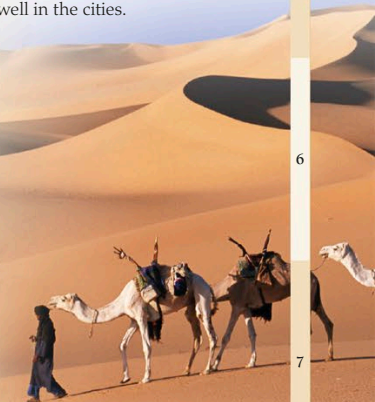
Ruins of a Roman bath at Carthage

The seeds from dates can be roasted and ground to make a traditional date coffee.



SURVIVAL IN THE SAHARA

The Sahara Desert covers almost one-third of Africa and is an inhospitable place to live with high daytime temperatures and freezing nights. The Tuareg are nomads for whom the desert is home. Traditionally, they keep camels for transport and to provide meat, milk, and hides. Many Tuareg now live in mountain areas or dwell in the cities.



Tuareg nomads in the Sahara carrying salt to trade in markets

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LIBYAN OIL RESOURCES

The discovery of oil and gas in 1959 brought considerable wealth to Libya, and by 2010 oil and gas made up 95 percent of the country's exports. Since 2015, however, civil war, political chaos, and low oil prices have made life hard for Libyans.

Libyan oil field